

## **Strong 2-♣ Opening**

Open 2♣ on any hand containing 22 or more points.

OR, open 2♣ with a hand containing 19-21 points and with 9+ playing tricks.

There are several methods of responding. For these Deals use the 2♦ Negative for all hands with 7 or fewer points. Any other response shows 8 or more points.

The 2♣ bid is artificial; Opener's second bid describes her hand.

2NT shows a balanced 22-24 point hand

3NT shows a balanced 25-27 point hand

2 of a suit shows a 5-card or longer suit

With a very weak hand (0-3 points) Responder should bid the "second negative" at his second turn. This is usually 3♣, but if Opener bids 3♣ then it is 3♦. If Opener should bid 3♦ at his second turn the second negative bid is 3♥.

Later bidding depends on the partnership, but unless particular conventions are in use then later bidding is natural.



Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 7NT

Declarer: South

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6♦

Declarer: West

**Deal 1**

South Deals  
None Vul

♠ 7 6  
♥ T 9 3  
♦ J 5 4 3  
♣ A 9 8 2

8  
5 5  
22

♠ K J 2  
♥ Q 7 5  
♦ Q T 7 2  
♣ 7 5 3



♠ Q T 8 5  
♥ A K 6  
♦ A K 8  
♣ K Q J

♠ A 9 4 3  
♥ J 8 4 2  
♦ 9 6  
♣ T 6 4

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
| Pass         | 2NT   | Pass | 2♣    |
| All Pass     |       |      | 3NT   |
| 3NT by North |       |      |       |

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SOUTH expected to open 2♣, then bid 2NT at her second turn.

But NORTH, with 8 points and a balanced hand, responds 2NT, so SOUTH must adapt. She shows

her minimum, balanced, 22-point hand by bidding 3NT.

Since SOUTH has just the 8 points minimum that he promised, he passes 3NT.

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## Deal 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 9 8 7  
♥ Q J 8 2  
♦ 9 8 6  
♣ 7 4

4  
6 23  
7

♠ 6 5 3

♥ 4

♦ T 4 2

♣ K J 9 8 5 3

N  
W E  
S

♠ T 4

♥ T 9 7 6 3

♦ A J 5

♣ Q T 2

♠ A Q J 2  
♥ A K 5  
♦ K Q 7 3  
♣ A 6

West

North

East

South

2♦

Pass

2♣

Pass

3♣

Pass

2NT

Pass

4♠

Pass

3♠

Pass

4♠ by East

**Deal 3**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ T 9 6 5

♥ J 2

♦ 9 5 3

♣ J 7 6 2

22

2 5

11

♠ A 8

♥ K Q 4

♦ A K Q J 8 6

♣ K 4



♠ K 7 2

♥ A 9 7 5

♦ T 7 2

♣ A 5 3

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♠ Q J 4 3

♥ T 8 6 3

♦ 4

♣ Q T 9 8

West

North

East

South

2♣

Pass

2NT

Pass

4♣

Pass

4♠

Pass

5♣

Pass

5♥

Pass

7NT

Pass

7NT by South

**Deal 4**

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 9 7 3  
 ♥ 6 2  
 ♦ Q J 9 8 6 3  
 ♣ A 4

7  
 7 22  
 4

♠ A Q J 5 2

♥ T 9 8 7

♦ 5

♣ 9 6 2



♠ K T 6 4

♥ J 4 3

♦ T 4

♣ T 8 7 5

♠ 8  
 ♥ A K Q 5  
 ♦ A K 7 2  
 ♣ K Q J 3

West

North

East

South

3♦

Pass

2♣

Pass

5♦

Pass

4NT

Pass

All Pass

6♦ by West

♦

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When EAST opens 2♣ WEST has enough strength (9 points) for a positive response. But,

because her suit is

♦

s, she must jump to 3

♦

.

EAST thinks slam and uses Blackwood to discover that WEST holds one Ace.

That's all WEST needs to know to bid 6